Scobee, commander of the *Challenger's* crew, and the wife of crew member Michael Smith. I found it difficult to say anything. All we could do was hug the families and try to hold back our tears.

The *Challenger* disaster was a catastrophe that bestowed pain and grief on all Americans. But after a lengthy and thorough investigation pinpointed the cause of the explosion, we picked up the space program, the space shuttle flew again, and we launched a new program aimed at establishing a permanent station in space. In time, I'm sure this project will advance not only our knowledge of the universe but the state of American technology as well, and it will ultimately produce an economic payoff, as yet unforeseen, on earth.

Now more than ever, I'm convinced that the seven who died aboard the *Challenger* would want us to continue the space program. At the memorial service, Mrs. Smith handed me a card on which her husband had written a few words by H. G. Wells which he had intended to read from space. They expressed better than I could why the seven astronauts of the *Challenger* had lifted off into a blue sky on the morning of January 28, 1986:

> For man, there is no rest and no ending. He must go on—Conquest beyond Conquest. This little planet and its winds and ways, and all the laws of mind and matter that restrain him. Then the planets about him, and, at last out across the immensity to the stars. . . . And when he has conquered all the depths of space and all the mysteries of time—still he will be but beginning.